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The Theological Method

The Act of Reasoning in Speculative Theology

(*In ST*, I. q. 1, a. 8)

In his commentary on *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 2, Cajetan made reference to Scotus, who held that premises that are believed in—taken either from sacred Scripture or the articles of faith—yield conclusions that are also believed in, but not demonstrated. Thus, according to Scotus, no theological habit of science is generated by the theological syllogism, but rather a habit—distinct from faith—that is a type of wisdom, which is more certain than opinion. Moreover, for Scotus, syllogistic reasoning is not a necessary condition for theological wisdom *in via*.

For Cajetan, the mode of syllogistic reasoning is not a necessary condition for theology taken in an absolute sense. It is, however, a necessary condition for our theology *in via*. As was already shown, “demonstration,” but not the discursive mode of reasoning, is what is continued between the subalternate and subalternating theologies. The blessed see theological conclusions immediately in their principles without syllogistic reasoning, while theologians *in via* deduce theological conclusions from their principles through discursive reasoning; nevertheless, the demonstrations and conclusions remain the same both *in via* and *in patria*.¹

In the *corpus* of article 8, the first conclusion to which Cajetan refers is that sacred doctrine does not argue in order to prove its

1. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 2, n. iii; see appendix 2.

principles, but rather it argues to prove the conclusions deduced from its principles. Cajetan repeats the Aristotelian axiom: "No science proves its own principles."² Aquinas explicates his understanding of proofs and solutions within theology in comparison to metaphysics. The supreme philosophical science does not prove its own principle—its speculative object (*obiectum speculabile*)—through demonstration, but rather grasps it with certainty (*in modo intellectualiter*) through a highly sophisticated conjecture that presupposes, and is founded on, the demonstrations *quia* of *Ipsum Esse Subsistens*.³ Similarly, the principles of theology as a science or wisdom—the articles of faith—are grasped also with certainty (*in modo intellectualiter*) through the nondiscursive assent of faith.

After the more complete introduction of Aristotle's psychological and anthropological works within Western Christendom during the thirteenth century,⁴ William of Auxerre, in his *Summa aurea*, was able to establish that there are indeed demonstrations based on faith, namely conclusions deduced from the articles of faith:

[Theology], therefore, has the articles [of faith] as its principles, which, nevertheless, are principles only for the faithful, because they are *per se nota* to the faithful and thus require no extrinsic proof.⁵

William of Auxerre's theologizing contributed to the key identification of the object of faith with the *veritas prima*, and the articles of faith with the principles of theology.⁶ This proportion between the articles of faith and the principles of theology (*articuli : : principia*) formed the epistemic hermeneutic for Aquinas's conception of sacred doctrine as a science. Furthermore, since God reveals the articles of faith through sacred Tradition and Scripture—*in via*—there

2. Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, n. iii. Cf. Aquinas, *In I Post. anal.*, lect. 21, n. 5.

3. Cf. Tavuzzi, "Aquinas on Resolution in Metaphysics," 223–24.

4. For the three stages of the introduction of Aristotle to Western Christendom, see Congar, *A History of Theology*, 59–61.

5. Guillelmus Autissiodorensis, *Summa aurea in IV libros Sententiarum* (Paris Philippe Pigouchet [14.–1518?], 3 IV 1500/1501), III, tr. 3, cap. 1, qu. 1, fol. 131vb. Cf. Aquinas, *ST*, II-II, q. 1, a. 5, ad 2.

6. See Chenu, *La théologie comme science au XIIIe siècle* (1943), 61–62.

is nothing superior to this science and its principles. Therefore, Aquinas affirms with great confidence: “Since sacred Scripture, therefore, has no superior, it can dispute with those who negate it.”⁷ Sacred Scripture virtually contains sacred doctrine’s method of argumentation; that is to say, the articles of faith expressed in Scripture virtually contain all subsequent theological arguments and conclusions.⁸

Regarding the second half of this first conclusion, Cajetan states that Aquinas confirms that sacred doctrine argues from its principles to its conclusions. Aquinas bases his argument on the authority of the Apostle St. Paul, who—in 1 Cor 15:12ff—“argued that the general resurrection is proven from Christ’s resurrection.”⁹ In commenting on this Pauline passage, Aquinas links the effect of the general resurrection to Christ’s resurrection within the order of instrumental and secondary causality (including meritorial and exemplar causality), while the principal efficient cause is God himself.¹⁰ The Deity could have willed outside of this particular order of causes, which is why the articles of faith necessarily form the principles of sacred doctrine and are the most proper authority in sacred doctrine, since they alone reveal God’s wisdom, the ontological foundation for sacred doctrine’s principles as necessary truths.¹¹

Cajetan does not further develop the content of this first conclusion—that theology deduces its conclusions from the articles of

7. Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, c.

8. “Quoniam in Sacra Scriptura traduntur demonstrationes virtualiter” (Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 2, n. xii; see appendix 2).

9. Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, c. Aquinas gives as an example a theological argument derived from Christ’s resurrection, which is an article of faith (“On the third day he rose from the dead”) and the principle or cause of the resurrection of the dead, which is likewise an article of faith (the resurrection of the body). For Aquinas’s references to St. Paul’s *sylogizing* in his epistles, see *Super Gal.*, cap. 3, lect. 4 and *Super Rom.*, cap. 8, lect. 1. For Scripture as the normative point of departure for theological argumentation in Aquinas, see Wilhelmus G. B. M. Valkenburg, *Words of the Living God: Place and Function of the Holy Scripture in the Theology of St. Thomas Aquinas*, Publications of the Thomas Instituut te Utrecht, n.s., 6 (Leuven: Peeters, 2000), 223–24.

10. See Aquinas, *Super I Cor.* [reportatio *vulgata*], cap. 15, lect. 2.

11. See Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, ad 2.

faith—simply because the explication of the causes is the primary intellectual exercise of the entire *ST*.¹² Explication or syllogistic argumentation, however, is not the *only* intellectual operation of the habit of theology. As was already noted, Congar astutely observed that the Baroque Thomistic reduction of the formal object of theology to virtual revelation was absent in both Capreolus and Cajetan. This interpretation, made predominant by John of St. Thomas, though already present in Bañez (1509?–1560) and Suárez (1548–1617), became standard among the majority of Thomists until Chenu's 1943 edition of *Théologie comme science au XIIIe siècle*.¹³ This hermeneutic completely eclipsed the interpretation of Capreolus and Cajetan. The main problem with this reduction is that it downgrades theology to merely a habit of new conclusions virtually revealed. Even though Aquinas and Cajetan use the expression “the habit of the conclusions” (*habitus conclusionum*) in relation to theology as a science, it is never to the exclusion of theology's other intellective acts as a wisdom, such as ordering and judging.¹⁴ Moreover, the revealed light of the principles remains linked with the theological conclusions. In Cajetan, the formal object is not virtual revelation, but rather a broader participation in the divine light of God's wisdom (*Deus ut causans*), which is included within the more general notion of the *revelabilia*.

The second conclusion (in the body of article 8) is that sacred doctrine disputes by defending against those who negate some of its principles (the articles of faith) but concede others.¹⁵ The third conclusion is that sacred doctrine defends its principles by solving

12. For the explicative and declarative role of theology, see Congar, *A History of Theology*, 100–102, and Martin Grabmann, “De theologia ut scientia argumentativa secundum S. Albertum Magnum et S. Thomam Aquinatem,” *Angelicum* 14, no. 1/2 (1937): 37–60.

13. Cf. Congar, *A History of Theology*, 156–60.

14. Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 2, n. i; see appendix 2. Cajetan highlights that theology is a wisdom, which orders and judges; cf. *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 6, n. i. Aquinas held in his commentary on the *Sentences* that theology is a “habit of conclusions,” see *In I Sent.*, q. 1, a. 3, qc. 2, ad 3. The fact that he drops the phrase “habit of conclusions” in the *ST* does not necessarily indicate that he stopped considering sacred doctrine to be a habit of conclusions, but rather that—as a “wisdom”—it is not limited to merely deducing conclusions.

15. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, n. ii.

the difficulties raised by those who negate all of its principles (the articles of faith).¹⁶

First of all, Cajetan clarifies the difference between a demonstration, which is the resolution of a conclusion into its principles, and a solution to an objection, which is merely showing that something does not appear to be false, without proving with certainty that it is true.¹⁷ Thus metaphysics defends its own principles against those who negate some of them and solves the objections of those who negate all the principles of metaphysics, by pointing out that they do not appear to be false.¹⁸ Aquinas states:

It is to be considered, however, in regard to the philosophical sciences, that the inferior sciences neither prove their principles nor dispute with those who deny them, but leave this to a higher science; whereas the highest of them, i.e., metaphysics, can dispute with one who denies its principles, if only the opponent will make some concession; but if he concedes nothing, it can have no dispute with him, though it can solve his objections.¹⁹

Likewise sacred doctrine, a science that knows no superior, offers both demonstrations and solutions. It defends against those who negate one or some of its principles (the articles of faith) while conceding other truths (articles) known through revelation. In sacred doctrine, heresy is confronted within the interconnected fabric of the faith by arguing from one article of faith to another. It can only offer to solve the objections raised by those who completely negate all of the articles of faith.²⁰

In his commentary, Cajetan focuses primarily on solutions when dealing with philosophers who negate all revealed truths. In light of Aquinas's confident affirmation (that sacred doctrine is founded on infallible truth), Cajetan holds that all objections

16. Ibid. Cajetan notes that the principles refer to the articles of faith, as they exist as a multiplicity in the human mind, and not to the *veritas prima*, which is simple in itself.

17. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, n. iv.

18. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, n. iii.

19. Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, c.

20. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, n. iii.

raised against the faith can be solved, because the truths of the faith can at least be shown not to appear false. Cajetan distinguishes two methods for this type of defense of the faith or *apologetics* against philosophers who deny all the truths of the faith. One way is from truths believed in, that is to say, according to a “theological” approach. Cajetan gives the example that if an opponent affirms that a nature can only be one hypostasis numerically, we could respond, “I deny it, because God is Triune.” That would be a theological solution that basically solves nothing, unless the opponent would come to believe. The second way of defending the faith against the philosophers is from propositions known by reason, either simply or as regards a particular matter, by responding: “I negate that [a nature must only be one hypostasis numerically] in an infinite nature.” This paradoxical statement—that an infinite nature *can* have a plurality of persons—cannot be known, since there is no effective medium to demonstrate it. This is how a theologian solves objections from propositions known by reason concerning a particular matter: if an opponent were to question the accidents of the bread and wine remaining in the Eucharist, a theologian might respond by affirming that the accidents are not there on account of the form and matter of Christ’s Body and Blood, but rather they are sustained miraculously, by a relation to the first cause—God.²¹

Cajetan stresses that Aquinas is saying that when sacred doctrine defends itself from those who totally negate the articles of faith, it should do so not according to the so-called theological manner, from truths of the faith (*ex creditis*), but rather from propositions known by reason. Cajetan negates all criticism that such a solution according to reason would be not proper to the theologian, simply because sacred doctrine as the highest science employs extraneous arguments and principles in a ministerial manner. He acknowledges that certain persons are uncomfortable with this position, because they fail to make the distinction between demonstration and solution. In those particular cases where rev-

21. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, n. iv.

elation is completely denied, there can be no demonstration from the articles of faith, but the theologian can offer solutions without ever having to contradict an article of faith.²²

Once again, this confidence in the theologian's ability to offer solutions to such objections is founded on sacred doctrine's participation in infallible truth. Although such proposed solutions are not directly derived from the articles of faith, nevertheless, the truths of the faith assented to by the theologian provide an occasion for the intellect to uncover the defects in their opponent's reasoning in order to propose a solution.²³ Cajetan notes that the *Summa contra Gentiles* is a theological exercise in this type of defense of the faith.²⁴

The Act of Judgment in Biblical Theology

In his book, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries: Motive and Method*, Michael O'Connor does well by contextualizing Cajetan's scriptural commentaries within the Renaissance's return to the sources (*ad fontes*) and application of newly acquired methods.²⁵ He also debunks the myth that the primary motive behind Cajetan's development as a scripture scholar was the influence of Luther and the Protestant Reformation. Cajetan's interest in Scripture was principally theological and pastoral, rather than polemical.²⁶ O'Connor's study

22. Ibid.

23. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 8, n. v.

24. Cf. Cajetan, *In ST*, I, praefatio, 4. For the defense of the faith as one of the functions of sacred doctrine as a science, see Congar, *A History of Theology*, 99.

25. See O'Connor, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 60.

26. O'Connor cites examples of this conventional view of Cajetan as a biblical polemicist, see *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 2n4. Jared Wicks notes that Cajetan's interest in Scripture could well have been an integral part of the Renaissance renewal of Scholasticism; see Wicks, *Cajetan Responds*, 262n76. Other works that address Cajetan's role as a Scripture scholar include Paul F. Grendler, "Italian Biblical Humanism and the Papacy, 1515–1535," in *Biblical Humanism and Scholasticism in the Age of Erasmus*, ed. Erika Rummel (Leiden: Brill, 2008), 227–76, especially 254–55; and Allan K. Jenkins and Patrick Preston, *Biblical Scholarship and the Church: A Sixteenth-Century Crisis of Authority* (Aldershot: Ashgate, 2007), especially chapter 6: "The Origin and Development of Catharinus's Polemic Against Cajetan."

focuses strictly on the motives and methods of Cajetan's biblical exegesis. The methodology of Cajetan's commentary on *ST*, I, q. 1, aa. 8–10, however, better contextualizes the intrinsic link between theological speculation (article 8) and biblical exegesis (articles 9–10). In fact, the fluid passage within Cajetan's own theological labors from speculative theology to scriptural exegesis was consistent with the Dominican *ratio studiorum* and with Aquinas's own theological method.²⁷

O'Connor rightly notes that for Cajetan theological speculation is distinct from scriptural commentary.²⁸ Nevertheless, Cajetan maintains a continuity and unity between these two distinct intellectual acts within their single formal cause, that is to say, within the unique habit of theology. Theological speculation flows from theology's *act of reasoning*, while commentary on the literal sense of sacred Scripture flows from its *act of judgment*. Furthermore, speculative theology's act of reasoning is dependent on and in continuity with biblical exegesis: "Since—as Cajetan notes—in sacred Scripture demonstrations are virtually handed down."²⁹

These two distinct intellectual acts—theological or syllogistic reasoning and biblical or exegetical judgment—have the same formal cause, namely, the habit of theology.³⁰ Moreover, they also flow from the same principles, the articles of faith. Hence they are

27. In his encyclical letter following the General Chapter of 1513 (Genoa) concerning the reform of religious life, Cajetan stressed the importance of study and doctrine, detailing that the order of studies should be taken moving from grammar, to logic and philosophy, then moral and speculative theology, and finally Scripture: "Ponite siquidem non voces tantum, sed corda vestra in eius virtute expulsiva vitiorum, genitrice virtutum, duceque certissima ad caelestem patriam, et distribuite domos eius, ut quasi in quibusdam habitaculis distributi, alii grammaticae, alii logicae, alii philosophiae, alii casibus conscientiae, alii subtilibus theologiae quaestionibus, alii sacrae bibliae lectioni, studii sui praecipuas partes impendendo discant, ut in distributis domibus confessorum, praedicatorum, lectorum, doctorum, pastorumque praeesse et prodesse possint" (*Monumenta Ordinis Praedicatorum Historica*, vol. 9, 94), as cited in O'Connor, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 32n5.

28. See Michael O'Connor, "Exegesis, Doctrine and Reform in the Biblical Commentaries of Cardinal Cajetan (1469–1534)" (PhD. diss., University of Oxford, 1997), 27.

29. Cajetan, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 2, n. xii.

30. Speculative theology and biblical exegesis are "one science" because of the unity of the habit; cf. Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 3, n. i.

united in the same subject, the Deity (*ratio deitatis*). Just as the articles of faith are revealed through the habit of prophecy, likewise revelation itself is most properly interpreted through the habit of prophecy.³¹ For Aquinas and Cajetan, prophecy is the one source for both apostolic Tradition and sacred Scripture.³² Thus prophetic judgment is what ultimately determines the literal sense of the canonical Scriptures, because it is ultimately God alone who is the revealer and the Church's uncreated, infallible rule of faith.³³ The prophets, apostles, and evangelists (the secondary foundation of the Church)—as Christ's co-mediators of revelation and co-authors (*instrumentaliter*) of sacred Scripture—form the first necessary and created condition for founding the certainty of faith: "that our faith adheres to the revelation made to the Church, includes that it adheres to the revelation made to the principal members of the Church, namely the prophets, apostles, and evangelists."³⁴

The second necessary and created condition for guaranteeing the integrity of the faith is the Church's magisterium, founded on

31. "[P]ropheta autem ea quae sibi sub lumine divinae revelationis apparent, non secundum proprii iudicii interpretationem & dicit & scribit. . . . Veri enim prophetae aguntur à Spiritu Sancto ad interpretandum quae eis revelantur: & sic totum quod est prophetiae, Spiritui Sancto tribuitur" (Cajetan, *In I Petri*, 1.20–21, in *Opera Omnia*, 5:383a–b).

Influenced by Cajetan's *De divina institutione* (1522), Erasmus—in his *Hyperaspistes Diatribae adversus servum arbitrium M. Lutheri* (*A Diatribe or Sermon Concerning Free Will*) of 1526—argues against Luther that both sides of the debate (Catholic and Protestant) claim erudite and virtuous members, yet the sense of Scripture still requires the gift of prophecy, even in these post-apostolic times, for its correct interpretation, which—he ultimately concludes—is to be found in the Church's hierarchy; cf. *Discourse on Free Will: Erasmus—Luther*, trans. and ed. E. F. Winter (London: Continuum, 1989), 13–14. In addition, Erasmus warns Luther not to usurp from God the role of sole interpreter; see *Hyperaspistes*, book 1, *Collected Works of Erasmus*, vol. 76, ed. Charles Trinkaus (Toronto: University of Toronto, 1999), 204–5.

32. Cf. Cajetan, *In ST*, III, q. 42, a. 4, n. iii; *In ST*, II-II, q. 1, a. 1, n. viii; and *In ST*, II-II, q. 1, a. 7, n. ii.

33. See Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 1, a. 1, n. x.

34. Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 171, a. 5, n. v. Scripture's human authors—including their intentions—are a secondary or instrumental cause. Thus, human judgment does not *determine* the literal sense of sacred Scripture: "Ut subiuncta dicta intelligamus dicta quidem esse hominis, sed inspiratione divina dicta. Quemadmodum ergo in apostolis Spiritus Sanctus in die Pentecoste datus locutus est, ita et in Davide [. . .]. Non solum interna locutio Spiritus Sancti in eo describitur, sed etiam quod illa interna locutio prodit extra in exteriori sermone." Cajetan, *In II Reg.*, 23:2, in *Opera Omnia*, 2:169a. Cf. *In ST*, II-II, q. 171, a. 1, n. un.

papal infallibility—the Church's created infallible rule of faith. Papal infallibility is likewise a prophetic charism, dependent on apostolic Tradition and sacred Scripture for its material object. As will be shown, the literal sense is primarily what God as the author of sacred Scripture intends to make manifest to humans—in written form—as mediated through the charism of prophecy.

The theologian, as a believer, is totally dependent on the prophetic revelation of the articles of faith. Moreover, the Creed, a *summa* of the substance of the faith, is the proper interpretation or hermeneutic of sacred Scripture.³⁵ According to Aquinas, it is through the articles of faith (as its proximate principles) that theology resolves into its subject, the Deity (*ratio deitatis*). Cajetan's understanding of the habit of theology—that it is acquired through syllogistic reasoning and extends itself to scriptural exegesis through its additional regulatory function of judging its principles—not only is key for grasping the unity of the first question of the *ST* (sacred doctrine: what it is and to what does it extend),³⁶ but it also bears witness to the perennial tradition of the Church's theological mode of biblical exegesis (prevalent in the Patristic period), which judges (without proving) its principles according to a creedal hermeneutic that is grasped in the divine light of faith, the imprint of divine knowledge.

During Cajetan's lifetime, the instruments for Scripture study may have improved, for example, a return to the original languages and the availability of better translations; nevertheless, the acquired theological judgment involved in commenting on the literal sense of Scripture (as revealed and interpreted by the prophets, apostles, and evangelists) remained the prerogative and competence of the *magister in sacra pagina* on account of his more explicit knowledge of the faith. The theologian's explication of the literal sense of Scripture is of an auxiliary or supporting nature in relation to the Church's magisterium. Moreover, a theologian's scriptural commentary is never

35. See Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 5, a. 3, n. i. Cf. Aquinas, *ST*, II-II, q. 1, a. 10, n. iv.

36. John of St. Thomas's limitation of the formal object to the scientific conclusions influenced Chenu's 1927 interpretation of articles 9 and 10 as a rupture within *ST*, I, q. 1.

to be equated to the prophetic determination of the literal sense through divine inspiration, nor to the prophetic charism of papal infallibility (a gift of discernment and not of inspiration). This is why Cajetan rebukes certain non-theologian translators of Scripture, who—overstepping their role—attempt to explicate Scripture's literal sense: "it is your office not to explicate, but to translate."³⁷

In his mid-fifties, Cajetan sought to improve his own biblical language skills.³⁸ Feeling pressed for time, however, he employed Hebrew and Greek scholars to assist him.³⁹ This is in accord with the Thomistic methodology of a superior or architectonic science, namely the habit of theology, employing the inferior sciences. Clearly, for Cajetan, knowledge of biblical languages has its advantages, but it does not make a scriptural exegete; rather, the habit of theology, generated from the first theological syllogism, is the formal cause of biblical exegesis.⁴⁰

In conclusion, for Cajetan as a Renaissance Thomist, Scholasticism and biblical humanism were never opposed. Cajetan embellished his acquired habit of theology with the latest Renaissance scriptural developments, and thus he is listed among the Italian biblical humanists.⁴¹

37. "Testor ego quod inter hos labores dicebatur mihi ab interpretibus, Dictio Hebraica sonat hoc, sed non apparet sensus nisi mutetur in hoc alterum. Respondebam ego auditis omnibus significationibus, Non sit vobis curae si sensus non apparet, quia non est vestri officii exponere, sed interpretare: interpretamini mihi sicut iacet, et relinquantis expositoribus curam intelligendi textum sic obscurum. Si ego non intellexero, alius intelliget. Sic quod curavi ut de verbo ad verbum textum haberem Psalterii, qualem habent Habraei: utinam assecutus sim" (Cajetan, *Liber Psalmorum ad verbum ex hebreo versorum* [hereafter *In Ps.*], Prooemium, in *Opera Omnia*, 3:1b).

38. Cf. O'Connor, "Rhetoric and the Literary Sense," 109.

39. See Cajetan, *In Ps.*, Prooemium, *Opera Omnia*, 3:1a. For more on Cajetan's biblical assistants, Jean Daniélou and Juan Ginés de Sepúlveda, see Grendler, "Italian Biblical Humanism and the Papacy, 1515–1535," 255–57, and O'Connor, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 142–43.

40. The collaboration between a theologian or exegete and a language scholar is to be viewed according to the relation of theology, an architectonic science, to an inferior science such as the knowledge of languages. As was mentioned, according to Cajetan, the theologian, *magister in sacra pagina*, had the competence to judge the *literal sense*, while the expert in biblical languages could better translate the *word*. This explains the mutual need for collaboration; or, in the one who is both theologian and linguist, the proper ordering of those sciences.

41. Cf. Grendler, "Italian Biblical Humanism and the Papacy, 1515–1535," 254.

The Literal Sense of Sacred Scripture (*In ST*, I, q. 1, aa. 9–10)

Sacred doctrine is based on authority, and, as was just established, God, through prophecy (both by divine revelation, the uncreated rule of faith, and by papal infallibility, the created rule of faith), authoritatively determines both the literal and spiritual senses of the canonical Scriptures.⁴² Both the literal and spiritual senses of Scripture together compose the material object of faith; that is to say, the truths that they express—both manifest (literal) and hidden (spiritual)—are what God as the author of sacred Scripture intends to communicate to mankind through his divine act of revelation.⁴³ In his commentary on *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, Cajetan begins with the simple affirmation that in sacred doctrine, God alone—as author—has the power to accommodate both words and things to the signification of something else.⁴⁴ Hence, in contrast to the use of language in the philosophical sciences, a single word or passage inspired by God can possess a multitude of senses. In fact, this division of the God-inspired senses of Scripture is grounded in the distinction between words and things: the signification of words founds the literal sense, while the signification of things founds the mystical or spiritual sense.⁴⁵

The literal sense is primary among the senses of sacred Scripture, because by manifestly teaching the truths of the faith it lays the ground for the three spiritual senses: allegorical, moral, and

42. The prophet is a fully human instrument of the Deity; thus, prophecy includes—and exceeds—the prophet's intention. Cajetan describes a double divine action and a double human passivity involved in prophecy: namely, divine inspiration in the human will and divine revelation in the human intellect; cf. *In ST*, II-II, q. 171, a. 1, n. un.

43. Cf. Aquinas, *Qdl.*, 7, q. 6, a. 1 c.

44. Both Aquinas and Cajetan hold that the literal sense in sacred Scripture is primarily what God intends; Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, c., and Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. I. Cf. O'Connor, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 168–69. According to Aquinas, the human authors of Scripture, namely the prophets, did not comprehend all that the Holy Spirit intended to reveal through visions and words; cf. *ST*, II-II, q. 173, a. 4, c. Concerning the deficiency of human authors' comprehension of all that the Holy Spirit intended to reveal, see Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 173, a. 4, n. un.

45. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. I. Cf. *In Gal.*, 4:24, in *Opera Omnia*, 5:213a.

anagogical.⁴⁶ As Aquinas states, “nothing necessary to the faith is contained under the spiritual sense which is not elsewhere put forward manifestly by Scripture in its literal sense.”⁴⁷ The literal sense is “whereby words signify things” and it alone is the foundation for theological argumentation.⁴⁸

The literal sense includes metaphor.⁴⁹ Metaphors are “not said according to their proper signification, but rather according to some similitude to their proper signification.”⁵⁰ From the book of Genesis (3:1–15), Cajetan gives the example that the word “serpent” is not intended to literally mean the reptile, but rather the term is used metaphorically to *literally* mean the devil.⁵¹ Likewise the punishment “to crawl on its belly” is also employed metaphorically to *literally* signify the casting down of the devil. Cajetan states that the text demands such an interpretation, otherwise the entire pericope would be understood in purely an infantile manner.⁵²

46. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. i.

47. Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, ad 1.

48. Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 20. Cf. Cajetan, *In Joan.*, 2.4, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:297b; and *Commentaria in Matthaeum* (hereafter *In Matth.*), 19.9, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:86a.

49. Vincent Carraud wrongly maintained that Cajetan’s identification of the metaphorical sense with the literal is in opposition to Aquinas’s understanding; cf. Carraud, “Métaphore et sens littéral selon Cajétan,” in Pinchard and Ricci, *Rationalisme analogique et humanisme théologique: La culture de Thomas de Vio ‘Il Gaetano’*, 204.

50. Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 9, n. i.

51. See Cajetan, *Commentaria in Genesim* (hereafter *In Gen.*), 3.1, in *Opera Omnia*, 1:24a–b.

52. “Perspicaciter contemplare, prudens lector, has poenas, et perpendes puerile esse intelligere has poenas illatas animali irrationali, quem serpentem vocamus, ut hinc firmeris in intellectu metaphorici sermonis, tum hic, tum superius, ubi textus ipse ad metaphoricum sensum non solum invitat sed cogit” (Cajetan, *In Gen.*, 3.15, in *Opera Omnia*, 1:29b). Cajetan “is concerned lest the mysteries of faith be dismissed as fables and that those who might otherwise embrace the Christian faith would be discouraged by exegesis that was puerile, ridiculous and absurd” (O’Connor, *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 185). “Sunt autem sensus isti metaphorici non solum sobrii secundum sacram scripturam, sed non parum utiles Christianae fidei professioni, praecipue coram sapientibus huius mundi; percipientes enim quod haec non ut litera sonat sed metaphorice dicta intelligimus ac credimus, non horrent haec de costa Adam, et serpente tanquam fabellas, sed venerantur mysteria et facilius ea quae sunt fidei complectuntur” (Cajetan, *In Gen.*, 3.1, in *Opera Omnia*, 1:25a). Cajetan’s principle of “Scripture interpreting Scripture” can be applied to Genesis’s metaphorical reference to the “serpent.” In the Book of Revelation, there is a parallel passage that better explicates its meaning: “the huge dragon, the ancient serpent,

Aristotle prohibited the use of metaphors in the natural sciences. In sacred doctrine, however, they are—in a certain sense—necessary and useful, not because of any deficiency in sacred doctrine, but because of a deficiency in the human mind, which is more easily guided by its own natural knowledge into those truths that exceed man's natural capacity. Therefore, in our theology, just as there is a necessity (*secundum quid*) for recourse to phantasms and analogical language, likewise there is a necessity (*secundum quid*) for the use of metaphors in sacred doctrine, inasmuch as metaphorical language better facilitates the communication of truths that exceed man's natural knowledge.⁵³

Since the three spiritual senses of Scripture (allegorical, moral, and anagogical) are founded on the literal sense, they can never contradict it.⁵⁴ Moreover, it must be noted that through the spiritual senses God also teaches truths of the faith, but sometimes in a purposely obscure manner.⁵⁵ The spiritual sense, in general, is “whereby things signified by words have themselves a signification.”⁵⁶

Developing this latter point, Cajetan states that within the spiritual sense a “thing” stands as a sign of another “thing.” Things can become signs in two ways: first, in the very generation of the thing itself, that is to say, the thing generated becomes simultaneously both a reality and a sign of yet another thing or reality (just as the paschal lamb is a figure of Christ);⁵⁷ second, a thing or reali-

who is called the Devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world” (Rv 12:9, RSV). This is also the understanding expressed in the *Catechism of the Catholic Church*, n. 391.

53. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 9, nn. iii–iv.

54. See Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, c.

55. On preventing unbelievers from ridiculing the truth of the faith, see Aquinas, *Qdl.*, 7, q. 6, a. 1, ad 2.

56. Aquinas, *ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, c.

57. Commenting on the “paschal lamb” in Jn 19:36, Cajetan notes that the evangelist would have never employed the figure of the “paschal lamb,” which is the literal sense of Exodus 12:46, in a spiritual or mystical sense to the crucified Christ, if it had not been the indubitable intention of the Holy Spirit (see Cajetan, *Commentaria in Joannem* [hereafter *In Joan.*], 19.36, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:420b). As was mentioned above, God—the author of sacred Scripture—also reveals and teaches through the spiritual senses. This is why Cajetan freely invokes “the indubitable intention of the Holy Spirit,” because—as author—the Holy

ty already existing becomes a sign through the ascription of a new meaning (e.g., the cross as representing medical aid). This latter way of being a sign is not proper to sacred doctrine, since it is not proper to God; rather, it is well within the capacity of humans to assign new meanings or significations to already existing things or realities.⁵⁸

The first way of accommodating things or realities to significations—that is to say, by the very generation of a thing or reality itself—can also be understood in two ways: either universally or particularly. The particular mode of this type of accommodation does not exceed the capacity of humans, since anyone can perform an act or artificially construct an object in order to signify some other thing or reality (as the apple icon signifies the Apple Inc. brand). The universal mode—on the other hand—is proper to God alone, since it exceeds the natural capacity of creatures and thus is proper to sacred doctrine. For example, historical events narrated in revelation often signify other realities.⁵⁹ The historical event wherein

Spirit foreshadows in the Old Testament the future fulfillment that will be manifestly revealed later on in the literal sense in the New Testament. This is a perfect example of the universal mode of accommodating realities to significations—which far exceeds the natural capacity of creatures—whereby the reality of the “paschal lamb” and the historical event of the Exodus in the Old Testament signify the reality of the crucified Christ, our Paschal lamb, and the fulfillment in his new exodus in the New Testament.

Cajetan’s strenuous effort to determine the literal sense in his biblical commentaries was not to negate the role of the spiritual sense, but rather to eradicate any abuse of the spiritual sense. When the spiritual or mystical sense loses its mooring in the literal sense, the organic continuity between the Old and New Testaments is misrepresented. Typology—so beloved to the Church Fathers—is founded on the concrete realities revealed in the literal sense of the Old Testament, and these same past realities prefigure or symbolize—and this is the wondrous depth of their spiritual sense—an even greater fulfillment and unveiling in the realities of the New Testament.

For Michael O’Connor’s critique of Cajetan’s exegesis of “paschal lamb” in John 19:36; see *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 171–72. O’Connor presumes that Cajetan’s “professed exclusiveness with which he approaches the literal sense” (ibid., 169) all but negates any positive role to the spiritual sense “in opening up the meaning of scripture” and that it is something “to be used only as a last resort” (ibid., 170).

58. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. ii.

59. Cajetan comments on the passage in Luke where Christ opens the apostles’ mind to the sense of Scriptures: “*Et dixit eis. Summarie colligit scripta ad propositum. Quoniam sic scriptum est. Non solum dicit sic scriptum est, sed assumit pro ratione, dicendo, quoniam sic scriptum est. Et significatur per sic dispositio, modus et ordo gestatum et*

from the rock flowed water for the Israelites in the desert is a sign of Christ, who is the fount of spiritual water, as the Apostle taught: "For they drank from the supernatural rock which followed them, and the rock was Christ" (1 Cor, 10:4, RSV).⁶⁰

In addition, Cajetan concludes that the literal sense of a single word or passage can be multiple.⁶¹ In sacred doctrine, the literal sense is that which the author intended. Since the author of sacred Scripture is God, whose intellect comprehends simultaneously a multiplicity, therefore, in sacred doctrine, the literal sense can be multiple.⁶² However, an obvious doubt arises from this affirmation: namely, if there could be a variety of literal interpretations for any particular passage, which interpretation would be correct?⁶³

This fact that the literal sense could include many explanations can be taken in two ways. First, in an absolute sense—as St. Augustine held—a multitude of explanations within the literal sense simply attests to the dignity of the author.⁶⁴ Second, the various possible literal senses are to be examined in relation to other biblical texts (Scripture interprets Scripture) which manifestly reveal and teach—according to the literal sense—the truths of faith. When comparing parallel passages of Scripture, some interpretations could be excluded as being repugnant if they clearly contradict the manifest teaching (literal sense) of other biblical texts. As was stat-

gerendarum rerum quae subiunguntur. Et sic oportebat. Consequentiae vis significatur coniunctione vim affirmationis habente: ac oportebat illum ordinem, illum modum, illam dispositionem servare quae servata est, quia sic scriptum erat. Christum pati et resurgere à mortuis tertia die" (Cajetan, *In Luc.*, 24.46, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:275b).

60. See Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. ii.

61. Aquinas sets forth some principles regarding a multiple literal sense; see *De pot.*, q. 4, a. 1, c.

62. "Non inconvenit in una littera Scripturae, secundum sensum litteralem, esse plures sensus" (Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. iii).

63. "Circa hanc conclusionem occurrit dubium. Quia si sensus litteralis potest multiplicari, nulla erit certitudo quis sensus sit intentus ad litteram, quolibet praeferente suam expositionem interpretationi alterius: cum enim de intentione Dei non aliter constet, oportebit omnes litterae expositiones ut litterales acceptare, aut nullam" (Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. iv).

64. Cajetan, *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. v; . Cf. Aquinas *De pot.*, q. 4, a. 1, c.; and Aurelius Augustinus, *Confessionum*, bk. 12, chap. 31, in *Opera Omnia*, PL 32.

ed above, somewhere in Scripture everything necessary to the faith is put forward manifestly in its literal sense, even though some passages seem to possess a multitude of possible literal explanations. If a comparison of scriptural texts does not clarify the meaning of a passage, then the authority of the Church—through its ministry to the Word—can certify and determine the literal sense of that particular text.⁶⁵ As was shown above, Cajetan vigorously maintains that the Church's magisterium—founded on the prophetic charism of papal infallibility—remains subordinate to sacred Scripture. Thus he strongly negates any opposition between sacred Scripture and the Church's magisterium, stressing their identification in faith's material object.

In his biblical commentaries, Cajetan likewise seeks a consonance between passages within the unity of Scripture (Scripture interprets Scripture) and a harmony with the Church's magisterium (dogma as an interpretation of Scripture).⁶⁶ In the introduction to his commentary on the psalms, Cajetan sets forth some Augustinian-inspired principles for commenting on Scripture's literal sense. He states that two aspects of Scripture—in harmony with right reason—must be kept in mind: the material and the formal aspects.⁶⁷ As regards the material aspect of sacred Scripture,

65. "... quoniam fidei actus coniungitur obiecto materiali, idest creditis, per hoc medium, quia Deus dixit seu revelavit; et ipse habitus fidei inclinatur ad assentiendum propositis propterea quia Deus sic revelavit; sed quod haec vel illa, in hoc vel illo sensu, sint revelata, quia Ecclesia sic tradit credimus. Et rursus revelatio divina est infallibilis regula per se conveniens fidei: sensus autem Ecclesiae per accidens convenit fidei, ex parte idest nostri, quibus haec proponuntur. ..." (Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 1, a. 1, n. x); cf. *In ST*, I, q. 1, a. 10, n. iv.

66. "*Rursum scriptum est. Scripturam citasti; scito hanc scripturam non esse solam, et oportere scripturam scripturae consentire*" (Cajetan, *In Matth.*, 4.7, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:17a).

"Scripturus super quinque libros Mosi iuxta sensum literalem, novumque scripturae sensum quandoque illaturus, sub sanctae matris ecclesiae ac apostolicae sedis censura, rogo lectores ne precipites detestentur aliquid, sed librent omnia apud sacram scripturam, apud Christianae fidei veritatem, apud catholicae ecclesiae documenta ac mores. Etsi quando occurrerit novus sensus textui consonus, nec a sacra scriptura, nec ab ecclesiae doctrina dissonus quamvis a torrente doctorum sacrorum alienus, aequos se praebeant censores" (Cajetan, *In Pentateuchum*, Preface, in *Opera Omnia*, 1:1a).

67. "Circa sensum autem literalis duo (ambo rationi consentanea: altera circum rem: alterum circa modum) servare oportet" (Cajetan, *In Ps*, Prooemium, in *Opera Omnia*, 3:3a).

God instrumentally moves the prophet according to the totality of his being, incorporating all of the prophet's human knowledge, talents, and skills; thus, if the prophet writes a song, the song is the material unit of that particular prophetic revelation.⁶⁸

As regards the formal modes of certainty concerning the literal sense of the psalms, Cajetan lists four: (1) the revealed title of the psalm indicates the theme; (2) a consonance with the revealed authority of the New Testament; (3) the apostolic rule (*regula apostolica*); (4) the general setting of the psalm. Cajetan places special emphasis on the second (Scripture interprets Scripture) and third (the apostolic rule) modes for analyzing or commenting on the literal sense.⁶⁹

The principle of Scripture interpreting Scripture (n. 2) presupposes a consonance with the apostolic rule (n. 3), since both are formal modes of prophetic certainty—that is to say, they are the two aspects of divine revelation.⁷⁰ As was stated above, Cajetan's biblical commentaries also seek a harmony with the Church's magiste-

68. "Circa rem quidem, quod quilibet Psalmus habet unicam materiam, & non saltat de genere in genus. . . . Exigit quidem materiae subiectae ipsa unius cantici ratio, probat communis usus scribentium exposcitque divina sapientia disponens omnia suaviter ac per hoc movens prophetam ad scribendum, prout homini congruit scribere unum canticum, quod est servare unitatem materiae in uno eademque cantico" (Cajetan, *In Ps.* Prooemium, in *Opera Omnia*, 3:3a).

69. "Circa modum verò, meminisse decet: quòd quemadmodum homo docilis non parem exigit certitudinem in omnibus . . . ita docilis nullus exigit hic evidentem, omnimodam certitudinem: sed admittet certitudinem ex contextu partium consurgentem. . . . Primò ex titulo Psalmi, quando titulus materiam significat Psalmi. Et haec via sufficeret si omnes Psalmi tales haberent titulos. . . . Secundò ex autoritate sacrae Scripturae in novo Testamento. . . . Tertiò ex regula Apostolica. . . . Quo fit, ut ex horum apostolorum usu regulam didicerimus: quod psalmus quilibet Davidis ea de ipso dicens, quae de eo non verificantur, sed de Christo, intelligendus sit ad litteram de Messia. Et per locum ab opposito, quilibet Davidis psalmus in prima persona ea dicens de ipso quae de ipsomet verificantur, intelligendus est ad litteram de ipso Davide. . . . Quartò colligendo materiam ex contextu psalmi. Ubi enim quaelibet aliarum dictarum viarum decerit, hanc inquirere oportet materiam psalmi. Quocirca per has vias sensum litteralem investigavi, & exposui utcumque" (Cajetan, *In Ps.* Prooemium, in *Opera Omnia*, 3:3a–b).

70. As was mentioned above, the "apostolic rule" or "canon of faith"—the Creed—is necessary for determining the literal sense of sacred Scripture. Interpretation is an incollective act of judgment. If there is no reference point or "measure of truth" (Irenaeus, *Adversus Haeresis*, 1, 22, 1: *κανὼν τῆς ἀληθείας*), a judgment on the "divine meaning" of any passage in sacred Scripture—which, according to Aquinas, is the literal sense and simply exceeds human reason—cannot be made.

rium—a necessary created condition for guaranteeing the integrity of the material object of faith.

Luther regarded Scripture as a sufficient cause (*sola scriptura*) of the material object of faith. In addition, he held the habit of faith (*sola fide*) as a sufficient formal mode for the interpretation of Scripture with absolute certainty.⁷¹ This drastically differs from Aquinas's notion of a virtual material sufficiency in Scripture—“*sola canonica scriptura est regula fidei*.”⁷² In brief, sacred Scripture—the written expression of the material object of faith—virtually contains the whole of theology. Aquinas even affirms that the psalms *alone* virtually contain “all of theology,” “the whole of Scripture” and “that it almost seems the Gospel”; they contain the complete and universal doctrine of creation, providence, reparation through the Incarnation, and glorification.⁷³ As was noted, when dealing with Scotus's notion of the subject of a science as a sufficient cause in itself, Cajetan argued that the subject of theology as a science—the articles of faith—virtually contain the whole of theology, not as a sufficient cause *in se*, but rather as dependent on and in continuity with the secondary causality of the habit of theology, by which (*quo*) theological conclusions are deduced from the articles of faith.

According to Cajetan, the articles of faith virtually contain the whole of theology, inasmuch they are a certain participation in

71. “When it is said that Luther's *sola scriptura* is part of the Occamistic heritage, the basis for such an assumption can be found only in a letter Luther wrote his teacher Trutvetter on 9 May 1518. In answer to Trutvetter's obviously severe criticisms of the Ninety-five Theses, Luther says that Trutvetter was indeed the very first to teach him that ‘one owes faith only to the canonical books, and a serious hearing to all others (authorities).’ Now apart from the fact that it is a common medieval *dictum* that only the literal sense of Holy Scripture can provide for a theological *assertio*, it is precisely Ockham and the Occamists, in contradistinction to the nominalist Gregory of Rimini, who uphold Scripture *and* tradition as the basis of theology. Hence Trutvetter's teaching on this point is by no means an ‘extra-occamisticum.’ Rather to the contrary! Luther reminds his teacher of a basic principle which, when carried through, means the reform—or the end—of all scholastic theology” (Oberman, “Headwaters of the Reformation: *Initia Lutheri—Initia Reformationis*,” 63–64); and “A new conception of the role of Scripture arises amid the *initia reformationis*. . . . With Luther and consonant with a never-forgotten medieval tradition, Scripture is read as the only convincing basis for settling theological questions. But among those involved in the *initia reformationis*, Scripture is elevated to the same rank as *sola gratia* and *sola fide*” (ibid., 49).

72. Aquinas, *Super Ioan.*, cap. 21, lect. 6.

73. Aquinas, *Super Ps.*, prol.

God's own knowledge of himself. Nonetheless, in our theology *in via* the articles of faith are known under a certain aspect or formal mode, that is to say, according to the first and supreme foundation of divine causality. This is *why* and *how* the articles of faith come to form the macrostructure of the *ST* (*ordo disciplinae*). Moreover, faith's certain knowledge of the articles of faith is totally dependent on the mediation and formal causality of prophecy (Christ, apostolic Tradition, and Scripture). Thus, the theologian—as a believer—is ultimately dependent on God as revealer and uncreated rule of faith, who communicates to humankind his own intimate knowledge of himself through the necessary and created conditions of sacred Scripture and the apostolic rule, and who also guarantees the material object of faith through the Church's magisterium—the created rule of faith. Thus, prophecy is the formal mode for the certitude of sacred Scripture's literal sense and thus is the foundation of theological demonstration.⁷⁴

This completes the section on the theological method, which embraces both reasoning in theology and judgment in biblical exegesis. The concluding section of this chapter will unite Cajetan's theological reasoning, biblical exegesis, and his "ecumenical" sensitivities toward Luther in a brief examination of his explication of the literal sense of Matthew 16:18–19 in his *De divina institutione pontificatus Romani Pontificis*.

Cajetan—A Biblical-Ecumenical Theologian?

A closer examination of Cajetan's work as a biblical exegete reveals an ecumenical sensitivity to the theological realities raised by Luther in particular.

74. Michael O'Connor notes Cajetan's distrust of sibylline oracles and the cabala; see *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 216–19. The cause of this distrust is simply that these prophecies do not belong to the faith and do not possess the "divine certitude" needed for theological argumentation or preaching: "... hoc solum dicendum occurrit, quod Sybyllae, quae hic inter daemonum prophetas computantur, superius, in qu. II, art. 7, ad 3, inter personas in fide Christi explicitae salvatas computari videntur. Materias siquidem haec, incerta cum sit, quoniam de individuís non pertinentibus ad fidem est" (Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 172, a. 6, n. un.).

Recently a book written by the Reverend Cardinal of St. Sixtus has appeared, which completely refrains from attacking persons and avoids all insults. He treats his subject cleanly with arguments and texts of authorities, matching his astuteness with laborious effort. Would that Luther were attacked by six hundred books like this, which illuminate the subject without striking riots. Everyone would want to learn.⁷⁵

These words are taken from a letter written on August 13, 1521 by the Dutch Renaissance humanist Desiderius Erasmus. Considering Erasmus's strong anti-Scholastic stance, his high praise of Cajetan's *De divina institutione pontificatus Romani Pontificis* (February 18, 1521)—a systematic refutation of Luther's theological and biblical arguments against the divine institution of papal primacy—as a model of objectivity, brevity, and erudition is significant.⁷⁶ In fact, Cajetan's *De divina institutione* certainly influenced Erasmus's own exegesis of Mt 16:18–19.⁷⁷ In his 1516 *Annotationes*, Erasmus was astounded at those who so easily twisted these verses in favor of the papacy.⁷⁸ In his 1522 *Paraphrase on Matthew*, however, Erasmus significantly changes his position, affirming that Peter, the prince of the apostolic order, was indeed *personally* granted—through an inspiration from the Heavenly Father—the sure confession

75. Erasmus, Epistle 1225, nn. 215–20, in *The Correspondence of Erasmus: Letters 1122–1251*, vol. 8, trans. Roger A. B. Mynors (Toronto: University of Toronto Press, 1998), 276.

76. In *De divina institutione*, Cajetan “framed his teaching in the light of Luther's rejection of papal primacy.” Michael Miller, *The Divine Right of the Papacy in Recent Ecumenical Theology* (Rome: Università Gregoriana Editrice, 1980), 30. The papal bull *Exsurge Domine* (1520) condemned the following statement (n. 25 of the 41 condemned propositions) attributed to Luther: “Romanus Pontifex, Petri successor, non est Christi vicarius super omnes totius mundi ecclesias ab ipso Christo in beato Petro institutus” (DS 1475).

77. See Erasmus, *Contemporaries of Erasmus: A Biographical Register of the Renaissance and Reformation*, vols. 1–3, ed. Peter G. Bietenholz and Thomas B. Deutscher (Toronto: University of Toronto Press, 1995), 1:240–41. Cf. André-François von Gunten, “Cajétan dans la correspondance d'Erasmus,” in Pinchard and Ricci, *Rationalisme analogique et humanisme théologique: La culture de Thomas de Vio 'Il Gaetano'*, 297–323.

78. “Therefore I am astonished that there are those who twist this verse to the pope (in whom, no, doubt, they seek the founder of the Christian faith in the first place. But not on this one man, but on all Christians, which Origen elegantly points out in this first homily of those which we have [1519 addition].) But there are those to whom nothing is enough save what is out of proportion . . .” (Erasmus, *Annotationes on the New Testament*; translation quoted from Jenkins and Preston, *Biblical Scholarship and the Church*, 249). For Cajetan's familiarity with Erasmus's *Annotationes*, see O'Connor, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 135.

of Christ's identity according to a certain and indubitable judgement:

You, He says, who ought to know rightly about me, *who do you say that I am?* Here *Simon Peter*, as he was the most loved by Jesus, [and] as the future prince of the apostolic order, responded in the name of all: *Thou art the very Christ, the Son of the living God*, not bringing forth a suspicion, but rather confessing with a certain and indubitable judgment [*sententia*] that he is the Messiah promised by the prophets, and—in a singular manner—the Son of God. Jesus, delighting in this glad and solid profession, *Blessed art thou*—he says—*Simon, son of John*. This word is not given to you (*tibi*) by human affection, but rather the Heavenly Father placed it—by a secret inspiration—in [your] mind. For no one—in a worthy manner—knows the Son, except by the inspiration of the Father, who alone knows the Son. And not desiring to be thankless for the marvellous testimony with which *you* adorned me, I affirm that *you* are truly Peter [*te vere Petrum esse*], that is to say the solid rock: not wavering here and there according to the opinions of the common people: on this rock of *your* profession [*saxo tuae professionis*], I will build my church—that is to say—my house and palace, that such a communion is fixed onto an *immovable foundation*, which no powers from the reign of Tartarus can prevail against.⁷⁹

Equally telling is the stony silence on the Protestant side regarding Cajetan's *De divina institutione*.⁸⁰ Sometimes the best—or only—defense against a good argument is to ignore it. Hence, *De divina institutione* deserves a second look not only because of its direct influence on Cajetan's contemporaries and its future influence on the First Vatican Council's dogmatic pronouncement on papal primacy and infallibility, but also because of its perennial ecumenical spirit.⁸¹

79. Erasmus, "Paraphrase on Matthew," chap. 16, in *Desiderii Erasmi Roterodami Opera Omnia Emendatiora Et Actiora*, vol. 7, ed. Jean Le Clerc and Wallace K. Ferguson (Charleston, S.C.: Nabu Press, 2011), 92–93; translation is my own.

80. See Wicks, *Cajetan Responds*, 31.

81. Archbishop Vincent Ferrer Gasser's *relatio* to the council fathers of Vatican I, on July 11, 1870, cites chapters 9 and 11 of Cajetan's *Comparison* (cf. *Acta et Decreta Sacrosancti Oecumeni Concilii Vaticani*, 7 [Freiburg: Herder, 1892], 391). Cajetan's *De divina institutione*, however, more clearly expounds that papal primacy is immediately from God and revealed in sacred Scripture. Fidelity to the truth of the faith concerning the divine institution of the papacy is both a motivator and guarantor of a true ecumenical spirit; cf. John Paul II, Encyclical Letter *Ut unum sint* (May 25, 1995), 14.

It may seem not only anachronistic, but also very paradoxical and provocative to refer to Cajetan as ecumenical. Nevertheless, in his Oxford address “St. Thomas Aquinas and the Spirit of Ecumenism,” Yves Congar’s reasons for speaking—with great caution—of Aquinas and the spirit of ecumenism, are equally, or even more, applicable to Cajetan.⁸² Congar notes that in ecumenism “one must hold to more ‘catholic’ principles of orthodoxy and judgment,” which is why Aquinas “awarded theological marks” to his opponents with care.⁸³ A lack of theological precision was the reasoning behind Cajetan’s opposition to the global condemnation of the forty-one propositions in *Exsurge Domine*, the declaration which ineffectively threatened Luther with excommunication.⁸⁴ “If ecumenism lives”—as Congar states—“in the recognition of the other and the effort to understand him,”⁸⁵ then it can be noted that Cajetan truly endeavored “to discriminate between Luther’s gauche formulations that could well disturb the faithful (*piis auribus offensiva*) and clear-cut matters of error or heresy.”⁸⁶ In *De divina institutione*, Cajetan’s main thesis is that the authority of the pope is immediately from God and revealed in sacred Scripture.⁸⁷ It is with this authentic evangelical insight that he debates Luther. Cajetan puts into practice the theological method expounded in *ST* I, q. 1, a. 8, by defending sacred doctrine against Luther’s negation of one of its divinely revealed principles. He confronts Luther’s heresy—concerning the divine institution of the papacy by the will and deed of Christ—within the interconnected fabric of sacred Scripture.⁸⁸

82. See Yves Congar, “St. Thomas Aquinas and the Spirit of Ecumenism,” *New Blackfriars* 55, no. 648 (1974): 201.

83. *Ibid.*, 203.

84. See Wicks, *Cajetan Responds*, 30.

85. Congar, “St. Thomas Aquinas and the Spirit of Ecumenism,” 201.

86. Wicks, *Cajetan Responds*, 30.

87. Cf. Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 15.

88. In commenting on the nature of heresy as addressed in the *ST*, Cajetan states that propositions can be against the faith *secundum se* in two distinct modes: either they are directly contrary to the articles of the faith and sacred Scripture or they are directly contrary to the determination of the faith made by the Church; see Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 11, a. 1, n. ii. According to Cajetan, Luther’s denial of the divine institution of papal primacy was a heresy because it went directly contrary to the literal sense of sacred Scripture. As

Luther's theological method demanded the absolute clarity and perfect certainty of sacred Scripture, so that the people of God, the hidden Church, could objectively know the path of salvation without any dependency on an ecclesiastical hierarchy (who, according to Luther, were not discharging their office for the most part) for the correct sense or interpretation of sacred Scripture.⁸⁹ In his exegesis of Matthew 16:18–19 in *De divina institutione*, Cajetan openly admits—along with St. Augustine—that the literal sense of this passage is obscure and that the spiritual sense is much more clear. He goes on to argue, however, that it would be intolerable for the spiritual sense to exclude the literal. It is beyond the scope of this present study to examine Cajetan's entire scriptural contribution in *De divina institutione*; therefore, we will focus on the literal and spiritual senses of Matthew, 16:18–19 as explicated in chapter 3: "The Keys are Promised not only to the Person of the Church, but also to the Person of Peter *in se*."⁹⁰

As noted above, the controversy with Luther gave Cajetan an occasion to reframe his ecclesiological focus from the head-body (*caput-corpus*) schema of *De comparatione* (1511) to the foundation-edifice (*fundamentum-aedificium*) schema of *De divina institutione* (1522). A key development in this shift was Cajetan's clear distinction between the pope's power to define (*officium fundamenti*) and his power of jurisdiction (*officium clavium*). As regards the *officium clavium*, Luther affirmed that the Universal Church—and not Pe-

Erasmus notes: "Luther recognizes no authority of any author . . . except that of the canonical books" (Desiderius Erasmus, "The Free Will," In *Discourse on Free Will: Erasmus-Luther*, ed. by Desiderius Erasmus and Martin Luther, ed. & trans. Ernst F. Winter [London: Continuum 2007], 12). Thus, Cajetan addresses Luther's denial of the divine institution of papal primacy—by the will and deed of Christ—with a detailed exegesis of the literal sense of Matthew 16:16–18.

89. See Martin Luther, "Refutation of Erasmus' Introduction," in *Discourse on Free Will*, ed. Winter, 101. As regards the "hidden church" and the unity of the Church made visible by the soul of the Church, which is charity; see Charles Morerod, "La controverse entre Cajétan et Luther à propos de l'excommunication à Ausbourg," in Pinchard and Ricci, *Rationalisme analogique et humanisme théologique: La culture de Thomas de Vio 'Il Gaetano'*, 273–74; and Charles Journet, "L'âme créée de l'Eglise selon Cajétan," *Revue thomiste* 17 (1934–1935): 266–74.

90. Cf. Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 16–25.

ter—was given the power of the keys.⁹¹ Moreover, this also seems to be the consensus of the Church Fathers.⁹²

Cajetan states that the Church Fathers' understanding that Peter—when accepting the keys—signifies the Church can be comprehended in two ways: first, that the Church accepts the keys when Peter accepts the keys; second, that the person of Peter does not accept the keys (implying that only the person of the Church accepts the keys). To negate the first way, which has the consensus of the Church Fathers, would be erroneous; while to affirm the second, that the person of Peter does not accept the keys, would be not merely erroneous but heretical, since it would negate the Gospel's historical sense; that is to say, the literal sense would be converted into the spiritual.⁹³

Cajetan declares that when it is said to Peter, "And I will give to *you* the keys" (*Et tibi dabo claves*—Mt 16:19), if indeed by Peter—not in his own person but merely *through him*—the person of the Church is signified, and if it is held that Peter is understood in the spiritual (*parabolicus*) sense rather than the historical or literal sense, then all sorts of license could be taken to convert any literal or historical passage of Scripture into the spiritual sense. For even Christ's death and resurrection could then be taken as a mere parables; since we die through sin, and the resurrection would thus signify our rising to new life. Such license would destroy the faith in the historical events as narrated in sacred Scripture.⁹⁴

Some biblical passages are simply meant as parables and thus require a metaphorical reading as their literal sense. Cajetan cites

91. "Patet ergo testimonio omnium publico, non Petro, sed ecclesiae esse claves traditas, non Romanae, sed universali et cuilibet" (Luther's *Resolutio* as quoted in *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 16n1), and "Vides ergo adhuc nihil ad Petrum proprie pertinere, nisi quod commune organum est omnium apostolorum" (ibid., 19n1).

92. As was noted above, in his 1519 addition to the *Annotationes*, Erasmus argued that Origen held that not to this "one man" (Peter), but to all Christians was given the sure confession of faith. In *De divina institutione*, Cajetan refers to St. Augustine's *De doctrina christiana*, 1.1, 17 (PL 34:25), and also to Cyprian's authority that the Universal Church, not just Peter, was given the power of the keys; see Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 19.

93. See Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 19.

94. Ibid., 19–20.

from Luke 15 the example of the prodigal son, in whom is signified the sinner.⁹⁵ Biblical parables, by their context, are clearly not historical narratives. On the other hand, narrated historical events (the literal sense) in Scripture can indeed signify other things or realities (in a spiritual sense), just as the crossing through the Red Sea signifies man's passage from vice to virtue.⁹⁶ Hence all care must be taken to correctly establish the *things, events, or persons* narrated in the literal or historical sense, because they form the foundation on which the spiritual senses are superadded. As was also stated, the literal sense is the foundation for theological argument. By contrast, the spiritual sense is for the edification of the faithful and not for argumentation in theological disputes.⁹⁷

Therefore, for an orthodox understanding of the truth of the faith revealed in Matthew 16:18–19, it is necessary to maintain the historical sense and not to convert the person of Peter into a parabolic figure. In the literal and historical sense of this particular evangelical narrative—our Lord's questioning of his disciples in the district of Caesarea Philippi—it is said that Jesus first listened to the other disciples' responses and finally to Peter's response, which was inspired by the Heavenly Father; then, Jesus promised to Peter the keys of the kingdom of heaven. The truth revealed in the literal sense is that to the person of Peter this promise was spoken, and thus only on the *historical Peter* can the spiritual or mystical sense of *him* signifying or representing the Church be superadded. In a similar manner, the historical Martha signifies the active life, and the historical Mary, the contemplative life. Moreover, it is through Peter that the keys are promised to the person of the Church (the spiritual sense), because, first of all, they were historically promised to the person of Peter (the literal sense).⁹⁸

It would be intolerable for the mystical sense to exclude the literal sense, that is to affirm that the keys were promised to the

95. Ibid., 20.

96. Ibid.

97. Ibid.

98. Ibid., 20–21.

person of the Church, while denying that they were first promised to the historical person of Peter.⁹⁹ The consensus of the Church Fathers—which correctly affirms that the keys were promised to the person of the Church (in the spiritual sense)—does not contradict the literal sense that Peter first accepted the keys in his own person.¹⁰⁰ Referring to St. Augustine's commentary on Psalm 108, Cajetan highlights that St. Augustine identified a twofold sense in Matthew 16:19: the literal sense—which is verified in Christ's words "to you, namely to Peter, I will give the keys of the kingdom of heaven" (*tibi id est Petro dabo claves regni coelorum*)—and the mystical or spiritual sense—which is verified within those same words (*through the person of Peter*): "to you, namely to the Church signified by you, I will give the keys of the kingdom of heaven" (*tibi id est ecclesie significare per te dabo claves regni coelorum*). The literal and spiritual senses of this passage are not juxtaposed to one another as if one is true and the other false; but rather to suggest that one is more clear than the other. In fact, St. Augustine held that—in Matthew 16:19—the mystical or spiritual sense was more clear than the literal:

certain things are said concerning the Apostle Peter—which seem to properly belong to him—but do not have a clear meaning (*illustrem intellectum*) except when referred to the Church—of which his person is known to be the figure, on account of the primacy he has among the disciples; as when [it was said]: *To thee will I give the keys of the kingdom of heaven*.¹⁰¹

99. "Has autem Petri conditiones trahere mistica interpretatione ad ecclesiam, quamvis sustineri possit, intollerabile tamen est, ut sensus mysticus excludat litteralem, Petrus excludat seipsam, auditor excludat eum qui audit, et Symon Ioannis vertatur in parabolics personam" (Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 21).

100. "Unde Cypriani, Hieronymi et Augustini dicta quae obiciendo allata sunt, verissima sunt, sed iuxta sensum mysticum. Sed non adversantur sensui litterali, quo (ut evangelica testatur historia) ipse Petrus in propria persona, cui revelatio facta est, respondit, claviumque promissionem accepit" (Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 23).

101. St. Aurelius Augustinus, "In Psalmo CVIII," *Ennarationes in Psalmos, Opera Omnia*, PL 36:1431–32: "Sicut enim quaedam dicuntur quae ad apostolum Petrum proprie pertinere videantur, nec tamen habent illustrem intellectum, nisi cum referuntur ad Ecclesiam, cuius ille agnoscitur in figura gestasse personam, propter primum quem in discipulis habuit; sicuti est: *Tibi dabo claves regni coelorum*."

This lack of a clear meaning does not deny the truth of the literal or historical sense—that the keys are first given to the person of Peter—but does account for the prominence of the spiritual sense in the explications of the Church Fathers.¹⁰²

To St. Cyprian's affirmation—that the unity of the apostles, and not just *one* apostle, accepted the keys—Cajetan applies the same reasoning: if you negate that the *one* Peter received the keys, you negate the literal sense and the historicity of the Gospel.¹⁰³ According to Cajetan, the unity of the Church flows from the *one* who literally received the keys, namely the person of Peter.¹⁰⁴

Thus, as a biblical exegete, Cajetan contributed to the dogmatic development of the Church's more profound understanding of the divine institution of papal infallibility and primacy as regards both its *officium fundamenti* and *officium clavium*. The essence of Cajetan's exegetical and theological insights on the papacy are consonant with the First Vatican Council's magisterium:

For no one can be in doubt, indeed it was known in every age [perennial] that the holy and most blessed Peter, prince and head of the apostles, the *pillar of faith* and the *foundation* of the Catholic Church, received the keys of the kingdom from our Lord Jesus Christ, the saviour and redeemer of the human race, and that to this day and for ever he lives and presides and exercises judgment in his successors the bishops of the holy Roman see, which he founded and consecrated with his blood [the martyriological structure of papal primacy].¹⁰⁵

Cajetan's explication of the relation between the order of the Church (hierarchical and Christocentric) and the order of our theology (*ordo disciplinae*)¹⁰⁶ as flowing from and subalternate to

102. See Cajetan, *De divina institutione*, ed. Lauchert, 23–24.

103. *Ibid.*, 19.

104. *Ibid.*, 43.

105. Vatican Council I, *Pastor aeternus*, n. 3056 (July 18, 1870). Joseph Ratzinger describes the “martyriological structure” of papal primacy in *Church, Ecumenism and Politics* (Middlegreen, U.K.: St Paul Publications, 1988), 37–38.

106. As was shown above, the articles of faith—those concerning the Trinity (*theologia*, the *ordo originis*) and the Incarnation (*oikonomia*)—are the structuring principles of the *ordo disciplinae*. The certitude of articles of faith is guaranteed through the charism of prophecy, which is attributed to the person of the Holy Spirit.

the order of origins—the *theologia Dei*—is what makes his singular contribution toward a more profound understanding of sacred doctrine original, perennial, and ecumenical, that is to say, universal or catholic. As was affirmed above, theology—like metaphysics—does not prove its own principles. They are grasped (*in modo intellectualiter*) through the habit of faith and judged in an intellective act that flows from the habit of theology, and are all the while dependent on prophecy for the certitude of the truths of the faith. To deny the Petrine ministry its place within the structure of the faith and the structure of the Church is to deny what belongs to the revealed divine economy (τάξις θεολογίας); thus, the negation of the Petrine ministry has always been considered as heretical (well before it was defined at Vatican I) because it simply contradicts the literal and historical sense of sacred Scripture.

In his 1527 commentary on Matthew 16:18–19, Cajetan summarizes his earlier doctrinal understanding of the papacy without, however, engaging in any polemics whatsoever.¹⁰⁷ His goal in his scriptural commentaries was to explicate the literal sense. Cajetan was also well aware of the temptation for the papacy to gravitate toward the mundane.¹⁰⁸ Hence, in Cajetan's commentary on Matthew, he introduces some qualifications to the papacy, as Michael O'Connor notes: "the gates of hell may certainly not prevail against the Church; but this is not a promise that temporal powers, wealth and comforts will be preserved;"¹⁰⁹ "[a]ny temporal power claimed by Peter can only be justified if it is necessary to the kingdom of heaven;"¹¹⁰ the pope's "power to bind on earth" is qualified

107. "Vide huius lectionis mysteria per nos latius discussa in opusculo *De institutione pontificatus a Iesu Christo, ne eadem repetamus*" (Cajetan, *In Matth.*, 16.18, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:76a).

108. Cf. O'Connor, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 86, and Morerod, *Cajetan et Luther en 1518*, 18–20.

109. Cajetan, *In Matth.*, 16.18, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:76a: "Non dicit adversus delicias, divitias, temporalesque potentatus eius, sed *adversus eam*, quae constat ex congregatione fidelium in una fide, spe et charitate. Immo quanto contra ecclesiae temporalia magis praevaluerunt, tanto magis ecclesiae aucta est numero, vel merito, ut patet in actibus apostolorum, gestis martyrum et comparatione ecclesiae divitis ad olim pauperem." Translation by O'Connor, *Cajetan's Biblical Commentaries*, 86.

110. Cajetan, *In Matth.*, 16.19, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:76b: "Tota Petri potestas refertur ad

by excluding “any power over those under the earth, in hell, and in purgatory,” and any suggestion “that such binding and loosing [of those under the earth, etc.] would be automatically ratified in heaven is not only foolish but blasphemous;”¹¹¹ and, finally, “Peter must confirm, not dominate; the other apostles are his brothers, not his subjects.”¹¹² In his commentaries on Exodus and Leviticus, Cajetan also rejects as unscriptural the link—prevalent during the Renaissance—between the high priest Aaron’s headgear and the papal triple tiara: the tiara was made of silk and gold, when only linen is prescribed in Scripture.¹¹³

In conclusion, St. John Paul II’s call—in his encyclical letter *Ut unum sint*—for “the whole lesson of the Gospel . . . [to] be constantly read anew, so that the exercise of the Petrine ministry may lose

regnum coelorum, ad gubernandum mundum in ordine ad regnum coelorum, in ordine ad salutem animarum, in ordine ad ea quibus regnum coelorum in hominibus servatur ac augetur quae constant esse bona spiritualia. Quo fit ut temporalia non comprehendantur sub potestate Petri, nisi relata ad spiritualia.” Translation by O’Connor, *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 86.

111. Cajetan, *In Matth.*, 16.19, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:76b: “Limitabitur hinc potestas Petri ad ea quae super terram liganda, aut solvenda sunt, ad differentiam eorum quae sunt sub terra, qualia sunt quae sunt apud inferos aut purgatorium. Illa enim sicut exempta sunt a cognitione Petri, non enim potest Petrus cognoscere causas eorum, ita exempta sunt a iurisdictione Petri. Transierunt siquidem a foro militantis ecclesiae ad forum Iesu Christi regnantis in coelo”; and “Admiranda efficacia ut ligatio a Petro facta super terram penetret coelos, sed tam stupenda efficacia quemadmodum terribilis est ligatio a Petro, ita librandi traditur ab ipso Petro. Colligere siquidem hinc potest, et debet quod non ad libitum ligat super terram, sed tunc tantum quando vinculum ratificatur in coelis, alioquin voluntarias immo etiam malas Petri ligationes et solutiones, coelestis cogeretur curia approbare, quod est non solum stultum, sed blasphemum.” Translation by O’Connor, *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 87.

112. Cajetan, *In Luc.*, 22.32, in *Opera Omnia*, 4:265a: “Officium confirmandi fratres praedicat futurum Petri. Et hinc tollit occasionem recidivae contentionis. Sed vide quod non subditos sed fratres vult haberi reliquos a Petro. Vide quod officium non dominandi, sed confirmandi in bono fidei, spei et charitatis praenunciat ac mandat.” Translation by O’Connor, *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 87–88.

113. “Veruntamen in litera, neque hic, neque in Levit. tam octavo quam decimoseptimo invenitur cidaris, nisi linea. Multa enim de his ornamentis referuntur quae facilius reici possunt, quia scripturae auctoritate carent. Distinguitur tamen in mitram et pileum, seu tiaram, ut patebit” (Cajetan, *In Ex.*, 28.4, I, 238a); “Ubi clare vides non sericam, aut auream, sed lineam scribi mitram pontificis” (*In Ex.*, 28.39, I, 242b); “Attende prudens lector quod in sancto sanctorum Pontifex nec auratis nec sericis utebatur, sed mere lineis” (*Commentaria in Leviticum*, 16.4, in *Opera Omnia*, 1:307a). Cf. O’Connor, *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 90–91.

nothing of its authenticity and transparency,”¹¹⁴ should include Cajetan’s various theological works on the papacy—and most especially his reading anew of the Gospels in his biblical commentaries—as an important testimony in the patient and fraternal dialogue on this subject.¹¹⁵ It is beyond the scope of this book, but it would also be fruitful to examine Cajetan’s doctrine on papal primacy and infallibility in the light of the Second Vatican Council’s development of doctrine on the episcopal college, most especially with reference to how episcopal collegiality is bound by previous papal and magisterial acts. As Cajetan noted, every pope binds himself and his successors when he exercises the papal charism of defining matters of faith on account of the divine assistance present in that act, which is handed down in the Church through the divine light of Tradition, preserving a continuity and unity of faith in every epoch.¹¹⁶

As a biblical exegete, Cajetan sought to hear (*sentire cum ecclesia*) the Heavenly Father’s voice—as recorded in Holy Writ—unveiling, within the economy of salvation history, the divine institution of the papacy; as a speculative theologian, he sought to explicate—from that divinely revealed article of faith concerning the Petrine ministry—what is perennial and universal (catholic) in the papacy’s *officium fundamenti* and *officium clavium*; and, as a theologian in the service of the suffering Renaissance Church, he sought the Church’s renewal by a return to its origins and through a profound analysis of what was reformable in the papacy and in the Church itself.¹¹⁷ Cajetan’s life-long labor—as a speculative theologian, bib-

114. John Paul II, Encyclical Letter *Ut unum sint* (May 25, 1995), n. 93.

115. *Ibid.*, n. 96.

116. Cf. Cajetan, *In ST*, II-II, q. 1, a. 10, n. v.

117. Cf. “1.2 Cajetan et la réforme de l’Eglise,” in Morerod, *Cajetan et Luther en 1518*, 15–22. O’Connor comments on Cajetan’s thoughts on the reform of the liturgy: “He complains about the excesses of some liturgical music: it is better to have none at all, than to have an unintelligible cacophony. He claims the authority of Paul in support of vernacular prayers (echoing the opinion, but not the tone, of Erasmus on the same passage). Where prayers are said publicly, in the hearing of both clergy and people, it would contribute more to the building up of the Church if they were said in the vernacular” (O’Connor, *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 80–81). On liturgical music, see Cajetan, *In I Cor.*, 13.19, in *Opera*

lical exegete, and church reformer—took its origin in and flowed from his acquired habit of theology, which was the particular object of this present study.

Omnia, 5:137a–b. On prayers said in the vernacular, see *In I Cor.*, 14.17, in *Opera Omnia*, 5:137a: “dici lingua communi clericis et populo, quam dici latine;” cf. also *Responsiones*, in *Opera Omnia*, 470. For Cajetan’s thoughts on communion under both species and clerical marriage, see O’Connor, *Cajetan’s Biblical Commentaries*, 53, and Wicks, *Cajetan Responds*, 288n5.